



# Oracle's Prophecy: Dodge This!

Oracle: "Sorry, kid. You got the gift, but it looks like you're waiting for something."

Oracle has almost acquired Sun Microsystems. By the end of this summer, the details of the deal will be out. Post acquisition, Oracle will become the world's biggest open source company. This could mean hard times for one of the most conservative and 'anti-competition' companies, Microsoft.

Microsoft dominates the market owing to business practices that allegedly kill competition. Microsoft's early penetration into the market is the key to its dominance. Microsoft was never much of an innovative company. It's a myth that Microsoft's focus is the desktop. It's simply a lack of competition at the desktop that ensures Microsoft's dominance in that space. Innovations and Microsoft—the two simply don't seem to gel. Ever heard of anything innovative from those at Redmond other than IE and WMP-- a bloated Windows Vista or W7 barely qualify as 'new'. Look at competitors GNU/Linux and Apple, and you will know what I mean.

The Windows-Office combo seems to be the only door MS has open for corporate users. But once Oracle takes over Sun, some radical decisions by the new giant may bring a balance into the market. In this hypothesis we will explore these frontiers.

## Welcome to the real world

Microsoft has only Windows. Oracle now has GNU/Linux as well as the Solaris operating systems. Oracle may change the licence of Solaris to make it compatible with Linux and then share features to make both operating systems richer. Oracle will then push forward Linux in the enterprise segment as the default operating system, using its influence over the loyal database customers.

The enhanced Linux will benefit home users as well. While Microsoft has only ageing XP or now a bloated W7 (read the 'Fight Club' article on Page 21) environment, Linux has GNOME for companies and home users, KDE for high-end users and XFCE/LXDE for old machines. Linux has OpenOffice.org and Koffice; Microsoft only has a controversial Office 2007. The suite of applications that Linux has surpasses Microsoft by light years—just peep into the repository of Debian, which has more than 25,000 different software.

Since Linux will now have the backing of Oracle, Microsoft will think thrice before making allegations of patent infringement to scare off customers. So, that could be an end to Microsoft's FUD tactics, and users will increasingly adopt Linux.